

CONTROLLED UNCLASSIFIED INFORMATION

Sole Source (Including Brand Name) Justification - Simplified Procedures for Certain Commercial Items

NOTE: If a Justification was approved for the preceding acquisition, a copy of the approved Justification for the predecessor action must be included in the staff package for approval of the instant Justification. This applies to Justification staff packages that are submitted for review and approval at a level above the contracting officer. The predecessor Justification will be used as a reference document by the approving official.

Is this a new or amended J&A Document? ☒ New ☐ Amended (Prior to Award Only!)

Is this a Bridge Action as defined in the [AF Bridge Action Reduction Plan](#)? ☐ Yes ☒ No

Funding level for this acquisition: [REDACTED]

Contracting Activity: 21st Contracting Squadron

Purchase Request / Local ID Number: [REDACTED]

Program / Project (and PE, if applicable): Command Console Upgrade

Program Type (PEO or Other Contracting):

Authority: ☒ AFFARS 5313.501 - 10 U.S.C. 3572, Implementation of Simplified Acquisition Procedures (41 U.S.C. 1901)

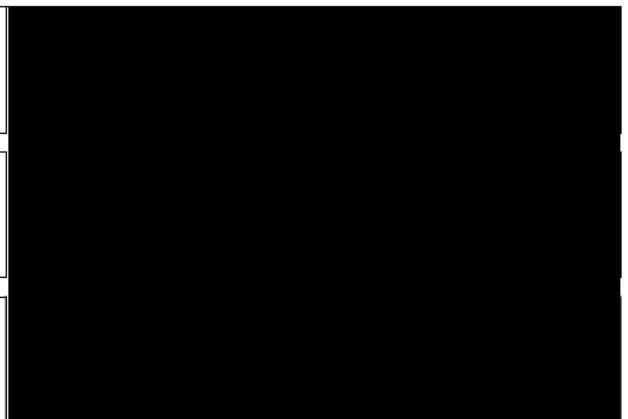
☐ AFFARS 5313.501 - 10 U.S.C. 3403, Special Emergency Procurement Authority (41 U.S.C. 1903)

Estimated Contract Cost (including options): \$382,233.54

Justification Type: ☐ Class ☒ Individual

COORDINATION ([AFFARS 5306.304\(a\)](#))

Date	Project Lead SMSgt Jonathan Taylor SBD 1/CSRCP/719556-4555
Date 21 Mar 2025	Contracting Officer Joseph Willard 21 CONS/PKB / 719-556-4789
Date 19 Mar 2025	Competition Advocate Kylie Hager 21 CONS/PK / 719-556-4835



[APPROVAL \(AFFARS 5306.304\(a\)\)](#)

Date 28 Mar 2025	Approval Authority/Contracting Officer Joseph Willard 21 CONS/PKB / 719-556-4789
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I. Contracting Activity.

Agency: Department of the Air Force (US Space Force)
Contracting Activity: 21st Contracting Squadron, Services Flight (21CONS/PKB)
Space Base Delta 1, Peterson Space Force Base

II. Nature and/or description of the action being processed.

Upon approval of this commercial brand-name justification for Unify, a firm-fixed price purchase order will be awarded under a new contract.

III. Description of supplies/services required to meet agency needs.

The Unify telecommunications infrastructure, implemented 14 years ago, has reached obsolescence and is no longer supportable [REDACTED]

[REDACTED] This transition will provide a robust, reliable, and future-proof communication platform for critical CP operations.

This upgrade aligns with the base-wide transition to VoIP, ensuring interoperability and compliance with Air Force Manual 10-207. This mandate outlines specific telecommunication requirements for the CP, including but not limited to: E911, caller ID, call back history, 20-line conferencing/transfer, call recording, call roll-over, hot-line/direct dial, UHF/VHF/Secondary crash radio integration.

The requirement is to replace the obsolete Unify telecommunications system, a new firm-fixed-price (FFP) contract will be awarded. This approach, justified through a "Justification for brand name," enables an expedited procurement process while simultaneously promoting small business participation in government contracting. The total acquisition value [REDACTED] utilizing [REDACTED] structured as a single contract line item (CLIN) for streamlined project management. The project has an estimated date of delivery on or before July 30, 2025. The exact date for the start of the delivery is unknown at this time as it is dependent on approvals and coordination with Government Subject Matter Experts (SMEs) and the contractor, however, the Government intends to have performance begin as soon as possible in order to finalize the upgrade.

This project encompasses a comprehensive upgrade to the Colorado Springs Regional Command Post (CSRCP) telecommunications infrastructure. The Contractor will be responsible for replacing the outdated Unify components (formerly Siemens) Hi-Path dispatch system, based at the primary command post on Peterson SFB, CO, will include a complete upgrade to the the command post system.

This system will simultaneously support both Primary and Alternate Command Post facilities, ensuring uninterrupted communication capabilities in any contingency. The upgrade encompasses all necessary components: intuitive operator consoles, robust cabling and infrastructure, seamless radio interfacing, and an advanced voice recording system.

IV. Statutory authority permitting other than full and open competition.

AFFARS 5313.501 - 10 U.S.C. 3572, Implementation of Simplified Acquisition Procedures (41 U.S.C. 1901).

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V. Demonstration that the contractor's unique qualifications or nature of the acquisition requires the use of the authority cited above (applicability of authority).

The organization's existing HiPath 4000 system, supplied by Unify (formerly Siemens), requires an upgrade due to outdated components. Upgrading aging components in the Unify system safeguards against potential system failures, allowing the organization to proceed with its mission confidently. This strategic upgrade translates into tangible benefits, including substantial cost reductions on hardware, installation labor, [REDACTED] The inherent "plug-and-play" nature of upgrading within the Unify ecosystem translates to a significantly expedited implementation timeline. This streamlined approach eliminates potential delays typically associated with compatibility testing, new hardware procurement, and extensive rewiring, ensuring a swift and efficient transition. Moreover, by upgrading within the Unify ecosystem, the organization benefits from a familiar interface and functionality. This translates into a seamless transition for personnel, minimizing the learning curve and mitigating potential errors during the adaptation phase.

The existing deployment of Unify systems is used by Nellis AFB, Patrick AFB command posts offers a significant advantage: personnel transferring from other locations can seamlessly integrate into the upgraded environment. This eliminates the need for costly and time-consuming training on a new system, optimizing both human resources and budgetary allocation. Moreover, upgrading within the Unify ecosystem safeguards the existing connection to USAFA, a critical communication pathway currently secured by Unify's robust infrastructure. This strategic decision minimizes potential integration roadblocks, mitigates data migration challenges, and ensures uninterrupted, reliable communication between these key locations.

Opting for a known and trusted vendor like Unify to execute this critical upgrade significantly mitigates the inherent risks associated with integrating new technologies into a complex system. This strategic decision is further strengthened by the fact that the current contractor responsible for maintaining the system holds the exclusive designation as Unify's Master Service Provider. This distinct advantage translates into a smoother transition, minimizes potential technical issues due to their deep familiarity with the system, and provides a robust guarantee of both the reliability and security of the upgraded infrastructure.

VI. Description of efforts made to ensure that offers are solicited from as many potential sources as practicable.

A Sources Sought notice, published on SAM.gov on October 25, 2024, aimed to gauge industry interest and capabilities in providing comparable software solutions for the required system upgrade. While Frequentis Defense Inc. expressed interest, they were unable to upgrade the existing infrastructure as stated in the PWS and proposed a complete hardware and software replacement. Extensive market research identified only two potential vendors capable of meeting the specific upgrade requirements.

Direct engagement with Unify Inc., conducted during the procurement of a separate sustainment contract for the same system, confirmed that only one authorized service partner exists for Unify systems: MCS of Tampa. While MCS itself is a small business, it frequently collaborates with its protégé, Mainstream IP Solutions, an 8(a) certified company. Notably, the current sustainment contract is already being successfully fulfilled by the joint venture of Mainstream IP Solutions and their mentor, MCS of Tampa.

Given that both companies provided identical quotes during the sustainment contract solicitation, a similar outcome is anticipated for this acquisition. Following the successful completion of their command post upgrade, Maxwell Air Force Base sought proposals for a new communications system. After reviewing bids from MCS of Tampa (Unify) and World Wide Tech (Motorola), the base selected MCS of Tampa. Their proposal offered a comparable solution at a considerably lower cost, with World Wide Tech's quote being double that of MCS of Tampa.

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VII. Determination by the Contracting Officer that the anticipated cost to the Government will be fair and reasonable.

The Contracting Officer will ensure a fair and reasonable price is established in accordance with FAR 13.106-3(a)(2). Given the anticipated single-source response, price reasonableness will be rigorously evaluated through a multi-pronged approach: comprehensive market research, comparison of the proposed price with previously established fair market values from similar acquisitions, and meticulous analysis against an independently developed government estimate.

VIII. Description of the market research conducted and the results, or a statement of the reasons market research was not conducted.

Extensive market research, conducted in strict compliance with FAR Part 10, revealed a critical lack of competition and available alternatives for the required system.

A Sources Sought notice posted on SAM.gov yielded only one response, underscoring the limited vendor pool. Further investigation into sustainment contract FA251725P0007, supporting the current system, confirmed that Unify holds exclusive rights as the sole manufacturer, proprietary owner, and distributor of the necessary operating system, associated hardware, and compatible solutions.

Direct communication with Unify representatives confirmed their status as the sole provider capable of meeting the Command Post's specific requirements. This situation is further compounded by the fact that only one authorized Master Service Provider of Unify is equipped to deliver OpenScape Voice services.

IX. Any other facts supporting the use of Other Than Full and Open Competition.

Given the unique circumstances surrounding this acquisition, including the reliance on proprietary technology, the limited vendor landscape, and the absence of suitable alternatives, pursuing other than full and open competition is justified. This approach ensures the timely procurement of a critical system while safeguarding sensitive proprietary information. To guarantee uninterrupted performance after the initial one-year warranty period, a maintenance service contract is would be established following the system upgrade implementation.

X. List of any sources that expressed, in writing, an interest in the acquisition.

See Section VI above.

XI. A statement of the actions, if any, the agency may take to remove or overcome any barriers to competition before making subsequent acquisitions for the supplies or services required.

The government remains committed to maximizing competition wherever possible and will conduct extensive market research in future system procurements and ongoing sustainment efforts.

XII. Certification by the Contracting Officer.

As evidenced by my signature above, I have determined this document to be both accurate and complete to

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the best of my knowledge and belief.

XIII. Certification by the technical/requirements personnel.

As evidenced by my (our) signature(s) above, I (we) certify that any supporting data contained herein, which is my (our) responsibility, is both accurate and complete.